

The Assets You Already Have

WHEN AN OWNER tells me they want to grow, they almost always reach for the same idea. Something new. A new channel, a new platform, a new tactic they have not tried yet. It feels like progress, because it feels like motion, and motion is satisfying. It is also, most of the time, the slowest and most expensive way to grow that exists, and it works right past the faster growth sitting untouched inside the business they already have.

This is the pattern I see more than any other, and it is quietly draining money from businesses whose owners are working hard and wondering why the needle will not move. They pour effort and budget into getting more, more traffic, more reach, more of everything at the top, while underneath them the business they already built leaks most of what it brings in. New customers arrive and slip away. Past customers are never heard from again. The same questions go unanswered, the same visitors leave without buying, and nobody notices, because everyone is looking forward at the next new thing instead of down at the value running out through the floor.

A business that has been running for any length of time accumulates value quietly, whether or not anyone uses it. Every visitor, every sale, every question, every review leaves something behind, and those leftovers are worth real money to an owner who knows what to do with them. Most owners never go back and touch any of it, not because they are careless, but because using it properly used to take time nobody had, so it stayed on the someday list and someday never came.

The growth you want is probably already here

The uncomfortable, and freeing, truth is that the growth most owners are chasing is not out there waiting to be found. It is right here, already inside the business, in the gap between what the business could be doing with what it has and what it is actually doing. Closing that gap is almost always cheaper, faster, and more reliable than chasing something new, because the raw material already exists. You are not building an audience from scratch or inventing a product. You are collecting value you already created and left on the floor.

This matters even more now, because the reason all of it went undone has quietly disappeared. The work of actually using what a business owns, reading everything customers have told you, reaching the people who drifted away, turning what you already know into more sales, used to be slow, manual, and easy to postpone forever. It is not anymore. What changed is not the value hiding in your business. That was always there. What

changed is that capturing it is now fast enough to be worth doing, which turns a someday task into a this-week one.

Why the order matters more than the effort

There is a right order to this, and getting it wrong is how owners waste months and money. The instinct is to start at the top, with more traffic, more attention, more new people. But pouring more in while the business leaks simply means losing more, faster, and at greater cost. The far better move is to find where the value is escaping, stop the leaks, make what you already have work harder, and only then turn on the tap. Do it in that order and every new visitor is worth more. Do it backwards, as almost everyone does, and you pay full price to fill a bucket with holes in it.

That single reordering, value first and traffic last, is the backbone of this entire book, and it runs against the instinct of nearly every owner trying to grow. The chapters ahead walk it in sequence, from where to find the growth you already own, to how to stop losing the people you already reach, to how to make each customer worth more, and only then how to bring in more. None of it requires you to be technical. All of it requires you to look somewhere you have not been looking.

The growth you are paying to chase is usually already inside the business, leaking out while you look the other way.

So before you spend another dollar trying to get something new, it is worth taking a hard, honest look at what you already have and what it is quietly costing you to ignore. Most owners have never done this, which is exactly why the opportunity is so large. The first step is not a tactic. It is an inventory, an unglamorous accounting of the assets already sitting in your business and the leaks already draining them, so you know where the money is going before you decide how to get it back.